

the tools like ADB and Fastboot. Installation links for different platforms can be found here - <http://dgit.in/SDKAndroid>.

We know that using the Command Line can be error-prone (if you type the incorrect command, or don't give the correct flags), so there's a handy GUI tool for Windows and Linux desktops that will do the job for you. Holo Backup (<http://dgit.in/HoloBackup>) works by connecting to your phone via ADB (you'll either need to connect via a USB cable, or if your phone supports wireless ADB, you can backup over Wi-Fi too). First, enable USB debugging on your device from Settings > Development > USB Debugging. Next, you will be prompted to authorize your PC to interact with your phone by confirming your PC's RSA fingerprint on your phone.

Then, simply open up the Holo Backup application on your PC, and choose the type of backup you want to perform. You can backup either your complete system, only your apps, the contents of your SD card (which includes your personal files like music, videos and photos) or a combination of these. You can backup your SMS messages to an XML file as well. Choose the destination folder to store the backups, and the tool will do the job for you. Restoring from a backup is also possible from within the same tool.

II. iOS

Apple's best-selling iPhones and iPads run iOS, an operating system that's always been more restrictive than Google's Android offering. This means a ROM-level backup like Nandroid is largely out of the picture. However, Apple's own offerings – iCloud and iTunes-powered backups, are well-integrated, seamless and fairly thorough, so there's no real need to consider third-party offerings.

iOS users can either choose to use Apple's cloud-based backup service, iCloud – which automatically backs up your data when your device is plugged in, locked and connected to Wi-Fi, or you can use iTunes backups, where iTunes backs up your data every time you connect your phone to your Mac/Windows PC. Of course, the two aren't mutually exclusive, and there's no harm in having both options handy.

Both iCloud and iTunes-based backups cover your data, including

- ▶ Photos, including your Camera Roll
- ▶ Contacts and contact Groups
- ▶ Call History
- ▶ Safari bookmarks, open tabs, web history and cookies
- ▶ Calendar Appointments